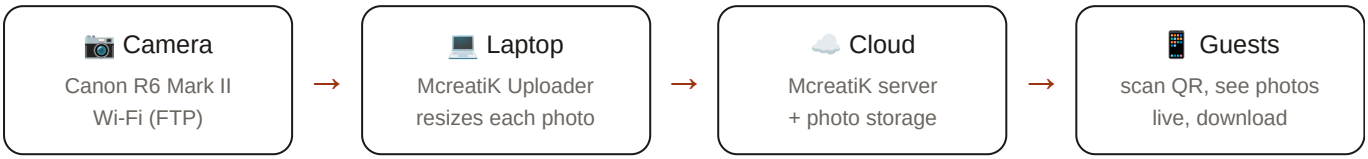
MCREATIK STUDIOS

McreatiK Live Gallery

Step-by-step guide: from setup to the end of the event



Each photo reaches the guests' phones in about **3–5 seconds**. Full-size originals stay on your camera card and laptop. Guests see a 2048 px web copy, which is sharp on any phone and small enough to load fast at a venue.

Part 1 What you need 2

Part 2 One-time setup (do once, at home) 3

Part 3 Before each event (day before) 5

Part 4 At the venue (30 minutes before start) 6

Part 5 During the event 7

Part 6 After the event 8

Part 7 Troubleshooting 9

Part 8 Quick reference card 10

Part 1 — What you need

Check this list before every event.

ITEM	WHY
Canon EOS R6 Mark II charged + 2 spare batteries	Wi-Fi transfer uses extra battery. Shoot **RAW+JPEG**: the JPEG goes to guests and the RAW stays on the card.
Windows laptop + charger, plugged in	Runs the McreatiK Uploader. It must stay awake for the whole event.
Android phone (hotspot) + power bank	Connects the camera to the laptop and carries the upload to the internet. Always use the **same phone**, so the laptop's address stays the same.
Mobile data	About **0.6 MB per photo**. 1,000 photos ≈ 0.6 GB. Keep 2 GB free to be safe.
McreatiK Uploader `mcreatik-uploader.jar`	The laptop app. It needs Java installed (already done on your laptop).
Printed QR posters	Guests scan them to open the gallery. Print 4–6: entrance, stage, tables.
Admin login	Your admin email and password for the dashboard.

Important web addresses

WHAT	ADDRESS
Admin dashboard	`https://mcreatik-instant-memories.mugundhan10.workers.dev/admin`
Guest gallery	`https://mcreatik-instant-memories.mugundhan10.workers.dev/e/<event-address>` You never type this: it is inside the QR code.
Server health check	`https://im-api.mcreatik.com/actuator/health` → should show `"status":"UP"`

> **Keep secrets private**
>
> Never share or screenshot the admin password, the uploader connection code, or the server's `gallery.env` file. Anyone with the connection code can upload photos to your event.

Part 2 — One-time setup (do once, at home)

This is already done for your current camera and laptop. Repeat it for a new laptop, new camera or new hotspot phone.

A. Laptop

1. **Install Java**
   Install a Java 21 runtime (for example "Eclipse Temurin 21 JRE" from adoptium.net). After that, double-clicking `mcreatik-uploader.jar` opens the app.

2. **Keep the uploader in one place**
   Keep `mcreatik-uploader.jar` in a fixed folder (for example `Downloads`). Keep the photo folder fixed too, for example `D:\Mcreatik instant memories`.

3. **Stop the laptop from sleeping**
   Go to Settings → System → Power & battery. Set **"When plugged in, put my device to sleep after"** to **Never**, and set the screen to turn off after 30 minutes or more.

4. **Allow the uploader through the Windows firewall**
   The first time the uploader starts, Windows asks about **"OpenJDK Platform binary"**. Tick **both Private and Public** networks and click **Allow**. A phone hotspot counts as a **Public** network.

B. Hotspot phone (Android)

5. **Set up the hotspot**
   Turn on the hotspot, set the band to **2.4 GHz** (the camera connects more reliably), and keep the same name and password every time. On an iPhone, turn on **Maximize Compatibility** instead.

6. **Connect the laptop and note its address**
   Connect the laptop to the hotspot. Start the uploader (see Part 4) and note the **Server address** in its **Camera Wi-Fi (FTP)** box, for example `10.x.x.x` or `192.168.x.x`.

C. Camera (Canon R6 Mark II)

The camera saves one network and one FTP address together as a **SET**. Keep **SET1 = home Wi-Fi** and **SET2 = event hotspot**.

7 Create the FTP connection

Go to Network menu → Connection settings → choose an empty SET → **Transfer images to FTP server**. Join the hotspot, then enter:

Mode	**FTP** (not FTPS or SFTP)
Server address	the address shown in the uploader
Port	**2121**
Passive mode	**On**
Proxy	None
Login name / password	**mcreatik** / the password shown in the uploader
Target folder	Root folder (default)

8 Set the FTP transfer settings

- Auto transfer after shooting: **Enable**
- Type and size to transfer: **JPEG only** (keep shooting RAW+JPEG)
- If the file already exists: skip or overwrite. Either works.
- Auto power off: **extend it** (Wi-Fi drops when the camera sleeps)

9 Test it

Take 3 photos. Within a few seconds the uploader shows **"Camera connected · 3 received"**.

> **Why always use the same phone?**
> The hotspot gives the laptop the same address every time, so SET2 works at the venue with no typing. If the camera ever shows **"Busy"**, check that address first (see Part 7).

Part 3 — Before each event (day before)

This takes about 15 minutes in the admin dashboard. You can do it from the laptop or your phone.

1. **Log in**
   Open `…workers.dev/admin` and log in with your admin email and password.

2. **Create the event**
   Click **New event** and fill in:
   - **Event name**: what guests see at the top of the gallery, for example "Priya & Arun's Wedding".
   - **Date**: the event date.
   - **Gallery address (optional)**: leave it as *auto*, or type a short name such as `priya-arun`. This becomes part of the guest link.
   - **Status**: choose **Upcoming**. Guests who scan early see "The first photos will appear here soon".

   Click **Create event**. The event dashboard opens.

3. **Add an uploader (one per camera)**
   In **Cameras & uploaders**, type a name (for example "R6 Mark II") and click **Add uploader**. A **connection code** (starts with `MCK1.`) appears. **It is shown only once**, so click **Copy code** now and paste it into a note on the laptop for tomorrow.

   If you lose it, click **New code** on that uploader. The old code stops working immediately.

4. **Print the QR posters**
   In **Guest QR code**, click **Print poster** to print an A4 poster that says "Scan to see the photos live". You can also use **Download PNG** or **Download SVG** to put the QR into your own design, such as standees, table cards or an invitation. **Copy link** copies the gallery link for WhatsApp.

5. **Test the QR**
   Scan the printed poster with your phone. The gallery should open and show the event name.

6. **(Optional) Set a delete date**
   Under **Privacy & data**, set **Delete everything after**, for example 60 days after the event. The photos are then removed automatically. Leave it empty to keep them.

7. **Pack and charge**
   Use the checklist in Part 1. Charge everything overnight.

> **Send the link before the event**
> Ask the host to share the gallery link in the family WhatsApp group. Guests who open it early come back on their own during the event.

Part 4 — At the venue (30 minutes before start)

Follow these steps in this order.

1. **Turn on the phone hotspot**
   Plug the phone into a power bank. Make sure mobile data is on and the signal is good. Move closer to a window if needed.

2. **Connect the laptop to the hotspot**
   Plug the laptop into power. Connect it to the hotspot's Wi-Fi.

3. **Close any old uploader**
   If the uploader may already be running (for example, it says "port 2121 in use"), open **PowerShell** and run:

   ```
   Get-Process java,javaw -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue | Stop-Process -Force
   ```

4. **Start McreatiK Uploader**
   Double-click `mcreatik-uploader.jar`. In the setup window:

   - Paste the **connection code** from Part 3, step 3.
   - Keep **"Receive photos from the camera over Wi-Fi (built-in FTP server)"** ticked.
   - **Camera folder**: click **Choose…** and pick `D:\Mcreatik instant memories` (or a new folder for this event).
   - Click **OK**.

   The window shows the event name and **"● Online — photos upload automatically"** in green.

   Already used this code before? The uploader remembers it and opens straight to the main window.

5. **Check the server address**
   In the **Camera Wi-Fi (FTP)** box, check that the **Server address** matches the one saved in camera SET2. If it is different, update SET2 (Part 2, step 7).

6. **Connect the camera**
   Turn on the camera and select the FTP connection **SET2** (hotspot). The uploader shows **"Camera connected"**.

7. **Take 3 test photos**
   Check all three of these:

   ☐ The uploader shows them as **Uploaded**.

   ☐ They appear in the admin dashboard under **Photos**.

   ☐ They appear on your phone in the guest gallery, without refreshing.

   Then **delete the test photos** in the dashboard (**Delete** under each photo).

8. **Switch the event to Live**
   On the event dashboard, set **Status** to **Live**. (Photos upload in any status except Archived, so a forgotten switch never loses photos.)

9. **Put up the QR posters**
   Place them at the entrance, the stage and the food area. Ask the host or emcee to announce it once: *"Scan the QR to see all the photos live and download them."*

Part 5 — During the event

Shoot normally. Glance at the laptop every 30–60 minutes.

Reading the uploader window

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS / WHAT TO DO
● **Online** — photos upload automatically	All good.
● **Offline** — photos are safely queued	The internet dropped. Photos wait on the laptop and upload on their own when it returns. Check the phone's mobile data and signal.
Counters: Waiting / Uploading / Uploaded / Duplicates / Failed	**Waiting** should go back to 0 within seconds. **Duplicates** are normal (the camera re-sent a photo). If **Failed** is above 0, click **Retry failed**.
"Waiting for the camera…"	The camera isn't connected. Check that the camera's Wi-Fi is on and that it is near the hotspot.
Open live gallery	Opens the guest view on the laptop. You can show it on a TV or projector.

Reading the admin dashboard

NUMBER	MEANING
Total photos / In gallery	How many photos were received and how many guests can see.
Processing / Failed	Should stay at 0 or close to it.
Active uploaders	Your laptop, shown as Online.
Cloud storage	Space used (about 0.6 MB per photo).

Curating while you shoot

- **Remove a bad or unflattering photo:** Dashboard → Photos → **Delete**. It disappears from every guest's phone within seconds.
- **Set the cover photo:** click **Cover** under your best shot. It becomes the gallery's header image.

What guests can do

- Scan the QR. New photos appear on their own while the page is open.
- Tap a photo to view it full screen and swipe between photos.
- Tap **Download**. On Android it saves to the Gallery ("Download" album). On iPhone a sheet opens, and they tap **Save Image**.
- In the Instagram or Facebook in-app browser, downloads are blocked. The app tells the guest to press and hold the photo instead.

Collect proof for sales (2 minutes, very valuable)

- Screen-record a guest's phone as a new photo appears live.
- Ask the host for a one-line testimonial before you leave.
- Note how many photos were in the gallery and how many guests used it.

Part 6 — After the event

1. **Wait for the queue to empty**
   Before closing the uploader, check that **Waiting = 0** and **Uploading = 0**. Closing early is safe: queued photos upload the next time you start it. But it's better to finish at the venue.

2. **Turn off the camera's Wi-Fi, then close the uploader**
   This saves camera battery. Closing the window stops the uploader.

3. **Set the event to Completed**
   The gallery stays open for guests, but it no longer looks "live".

4. **Back up the originals**
   The full-size JPEGs are in the camera folder on the laptop, and the RAWs are on the card. Copy both to your usual backup (for example the Google Drive desktop folder). **The cloud only has web-size copies**, so the laptop and card are your masters.

5. **Send the host the link**
   Copy link on the dashboard. Send it with a thank-you message and mention when the edited album will follow.

6. **Close the gallery when it's time**
   - **Archived**: the gallery is closed to guests and uploads stop. The photos are kept.
   - **Delete everything after**: automatic permanent deletion on a set date.
   - **Delete event now**: permanent and immediate. Only use this when you're sure.

Event status at a glance

STATUS	GUESTS CAN VIEW?	UPLOADS WORK?	USE IT WHEN
Draft	No	Yes	Setting up privately or testing
Upcoming	Yes ("photos soon")	Yes	QR shared before the event
Live	Yes	Yes	During the event
Completed	Yes	Yes	After the event
Archived	No	No	Gallery closed for good

Part 7 — Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	FIX
Camera says **"Busy"** or **"cannot connect to FTP server"**	1) Are the camera and laptop on the **same hotspot**? 2) Does the uploader's Server address match camera SET2? 3) Is "OpenJDK Platform binary" allowed in the firewall on **Public** networks? 4) Try toggling Passive mode in the camera.
Uploader: **"could not start on port 2121"** / port in use	An old uploader is still running. Run the PowerShell command from Part 4, step 3, then start the uploader again.
Photos reach the laptop but not the gallery	The uploader shows **Offline**, so the hotspot has no internet. Check mobile data and signal. Photos upload by themselves once it's back.
Failed counter above 0	Click **Retry failed**. Old failures from earlier tests can be ignored.
Gallery is slow, or the first photo takes about 30 seconds	The first photo after a server restart is slower while the server warms up. After that it takes 3–5 seconds. Take a test shot at the venue first (Part 4, step 7).
Guest can't download	They're in the Instagram or Facebook browser. Tell them to press and hold the photo, or open the link in Chrome or Safari.
QR opens "not found"	The event is in **Draft** or **Archived**. Switch it to Upcoming or Live.
Lost the connection code	Dashboard → Cameras & uploaders → **New code**. Paste it into the uploader (restart it if needed).
Dashboard won't load / whole gallery down	Open `https://im-api.mcreatik.com/actuator/health`. If it doesn't say UP, the server needs a restart (contact your tech support / Claude). Photos stay safe on the laptop meanwhile.
Camera lost Wi-Fi for a while	Nothing to do. When it reconnects, the camera sends the photos it missed. Every photo is also on the card.

> **Golden rule**
> Nothing is ever lost. Every photo is on the camera card, on the laptop, and (once online) in the cloud. If something breaks, keep shooting and fix it at a calm moment.

Part 8 — Quick reference card

Print this page and keep it in your camera bag.

Day before

☐ Create the event (status: Upcoming)
☐ Add uploader → copy the code
☐ Print QR posters and test-scan one
☐ Send the link to the host
☐ Charge camera, spare batteries, phone, power bank

At the venue

☐ Hotspot on, phone on a power bank
☐ Laptop plugged in and on the hotspot
☐ Close the old uploader (PowerShell command)
☐ Start the uploader → Online (green)
☐ Camera on SET2 → "Camera connected"
☐ 3 test shots seen on your phone → delete them
☐ Status → Live, posters up, announcement

During

☐ Check the uploader every 30–60 min
☐ Waiting = 0, Failed = 0
☐ Delete bad shots, set a cover photo
☐ Swap camera batteries early
☐ Record proof video, ask for a testimonial

After

☐ Queue empty → camera Wi-Fi off → close the uploader
☐ Status → Completed
☐ Back up originals and RAWs
☐ Send the link and a thank-you to the host
☐ Later: Archive or set a delete date

Camera FTP settings (SET2)

Mode	FTP	Port	2121
Server address	shown in the uploader	Passive mode	On
User	mcreatik	Password	shown in the uploader
Transfer	Auto, JPEG only	Shoot	RAW + JPEG

PowerShell: close an old uploader

```
Get-Process java,javaw -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue | Stop-Process -Force
```

McreatiK Live Gallery V1 · Guide version October 2026